Statement of Qualifications
Information Technology Specialist I (JC-522928)
Sahaj Bhadja

I am applying for the Information Technology Specialist I position with the California Department of Social Services because it aligns with my background in software engineering, cloud technologies, data systems, and user-focused application development. I recently completed my Master of Science in Computer Science at the University of Southern California with a strong academic record while gaining hands-on experience developing scalable software solutions in both research and production environments. In my current role as a Web and Backend Development Engineer at USC Annenberg Media, I develop and maintain web applications that serve thousands of users. I have improved application performance by implementing backend optimizations, caching strategies, and cloud-based deployments, resulting in significantly faster response times and improved user experience. My work requires close collaboration with developers, content teams, and stakeholders while maintaining high standards for reliability, accessibility, and security. Previously, as a Software Development Engineer at Aasma Technology Solutions, I designed REST APIs, contributed to microservices, automated ETL workflows, and improved CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and cloud technologies. I routinely analyzed system issues, identified root causes, and implemented solutions that reduced response times and improved operational efficiency. These experiences strengthened my ability to troubleshoot complex technical problems and deliver reliable software in Agile environments. My technical skills include Python, JavaScript, Java, SQL, React, Node.js, Flask, Django, AWS, Docker, Git, MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, and modern software engineering practices. Throughout graduate school I completed projects involving machine learning, artificial intelligence, database systems, distributed computing, and cloud infrastructure. I am comfortable learning new technologies quickly and applying them to solve business and operational challenges. Beyond technical ability, I value communication, documentation, and customer service. Working at USC has required me to collaborate with diverse stakeholders, explain technical concepts to non-technical users, prioritize competing requests, and consistently deliver high-quality solutions. I enjoy working in team environments where continuous improvement and knowledge sharing are encouraged. I am confident that my combination of graduate education, professional software engineering experience, cloud computing knowledge, analytical problem-solving skills, and commitment to public service will allow me to make meaningful contributions as an Information Technology Specialist I with the California Department of Social Services. I look forward to the opportunity to support the department's technology initiatives while providing dependable, secure, and efficient IT solutions for the people of California.